

Microsoft 365 Business Premium

The MSP Standard for Managed SMB
Clients

1

Standard stack for
identity, devices, email,
data, and endpoint
security

5

Major MSP service lanes
created from one license

300

User cap for SMB
Business plans

\$

Recurring revenue +
project roadmap
potential

Core message

Business Premium helps an MSP move from supporting Microsoft 365 to managing the client's identity, devices, security, and data.

Business Basic and Standard give users tools. Business Premium gives the MSP control.

Executive case: why Business Premium is good for an MSP

Standardize the stack

A consistent client baseline reduces one-off support, onboarding friction, and documentation gaps.

Improve security posture

Identity, endpoint, email, device, and data controls become part of the core service.

Create recurring services

Monthly security reviews, device compliance, license optimization, and QBR reporting.

Unlock project revenue

Intune onboarding, Autopilot, SharePoint migrations, CA baselines, data governance.

Increase client stickiness

MSP becomes embedded in identity, devices, data, and security operations.

Reduce tool sprawl

Microsoft-native controls can replace or reduce overlapping point solutions where appropriate.

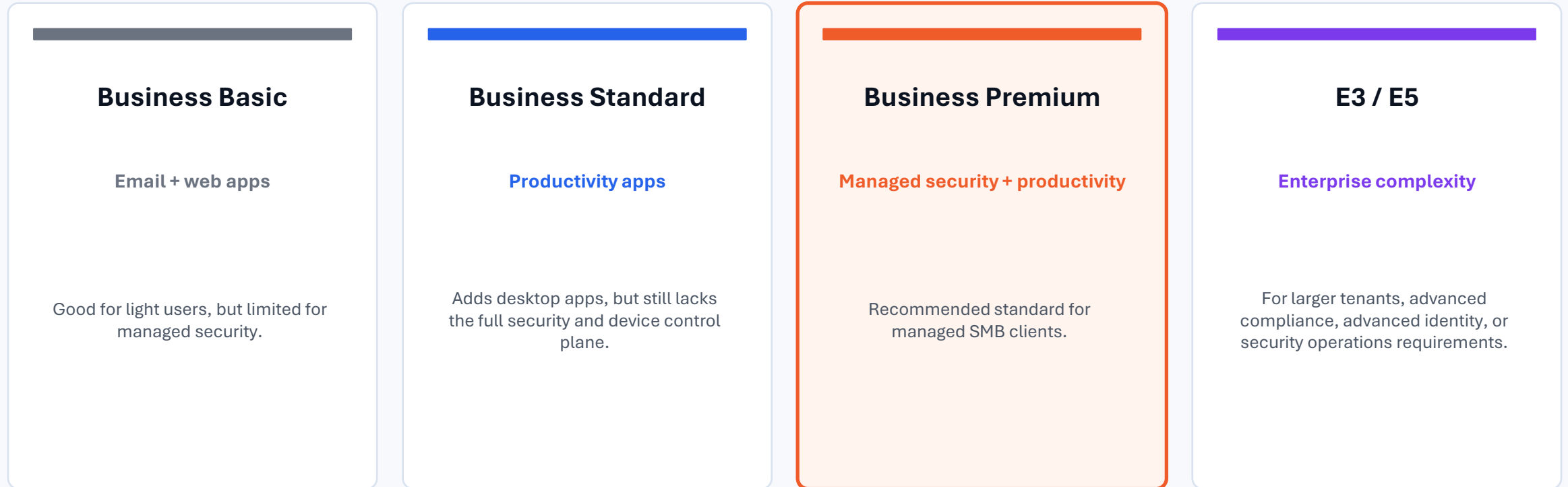
Management takeaway

Business Premium is the best SMB license to turn Microsoft 365 from a productivity platform into a managed services platform.

Use the license as the foundation for your managed standard — then layer backup, MDR, SIEM, RMM, or compliance services on top.

Business plan positioning

How to explain why Business Premium should be the MSP-recommended standard.



Best meeting phrase

“Business Standard gives the client productivity. Business Premium gives the MSP the control plane to secure and manage the client.”

The Business Premium control plane

The strongest pitch: one license connects the MSP to the areas that matter most.

One SMB license → many MSP control points

ID

Identity

Entra ID P1 + Conditional Access

PC

Devices

Intune Plan 1 + Autopilot

EDR

Endpoint

Defender for Business + EDR

@

Email

Defender for Office 365 + Safe Links

DLP

Data

Purview controls + DLP + labels

OS

Windows

BitLocker + Update for Business

✓

Reporting

Secure Score + Audit + Alerts

QBR

Operations

QBRs + recurring standards

MSP result: Business Premium is not about buying more apps — it gives the MSP a repeatable control plane for security, device management, operations, and client roadmap work.

Revenue engine: license + projects + recurring service

Business Premium creates a roadmap, not just a license upgrade.



Project revenue examples

Tenant baseline, CA deployment, Intune rollout, Autopilot, SharePoint migration, sensitivity labels.

Recurring revenue examples

Secure Score review, device compliance, endpoint risk, email threat review, license optimization.

Strategic revenue examples

vCIO roadmap, cloud-first migration, cyber insurance readiness, data governance planning.

MSP business result: Business Premium turns the client's Microsoft environment into a repeatable managed service model.

Security baseline: where Business Premium changes the conversation

Position security as part of the core MSP service, not an optional add-on.

1

Identity security

Conditional Access, MFA, admin protection, legacy auth blocking

2

Email security

Defender for Office 365, Safe Links, Safe Attachments, anti-phishing

3

Endpoint security

Defender for Business, EDR, vulnerability recommendations, attack surface reduction

4

Device control

Intune compliance, security baselines, BitLocker, update rings

5

Data protection

DLP starting points, sensitivity labels, encryption, sharing controls

Client risk story

“We are not just selling Office apps. We are reducing risk from phishing, ransomware, credential theft, unmanaged devices, and accidental data exposure.”

This is the security baseline most SMB clients understand when explained in business language.

Technical breakout: what MSP techs can actually implement

Identity

- Conditional Access baseline
- MFA + break-glass design
- Block legacy authentication
- Guest access controls

Endpoint

- Defender onboarding
- ASR rule rollout
- TVM recommendations
- Security alerts review

Intune

- Enrollment + compliance
- Security baselines
- App deployment
- Update rings + BitLocker

Email

- Anti-phishing policies
- Safe Links / Safe Attachments
- Mailbox intelligence
- DMARC/DKIM/SPF alignment

Data

- Sensitivity labels
- DLP starter policies
- SharePoint sharing review
- OneDrive sync controls

Operations

- Monthly health checks
- License optimization
- Secure Score tracking
- QBR evidence package

QBR and vCIO value

Business Premium gives better reporting material than “tickets opened and closed.”

Secure Score

Show posture trends and improvement roadmap

Device compliance

Find drift, noncompliant devices, encryption gaps

Endpoint risk

Discuss vulnerabilities, exposure, and recommendations

Email threats

Show phishing, malicious link, and attachment protection

Identity activity

Review MFA, sign-ins, admin access, and exceptions

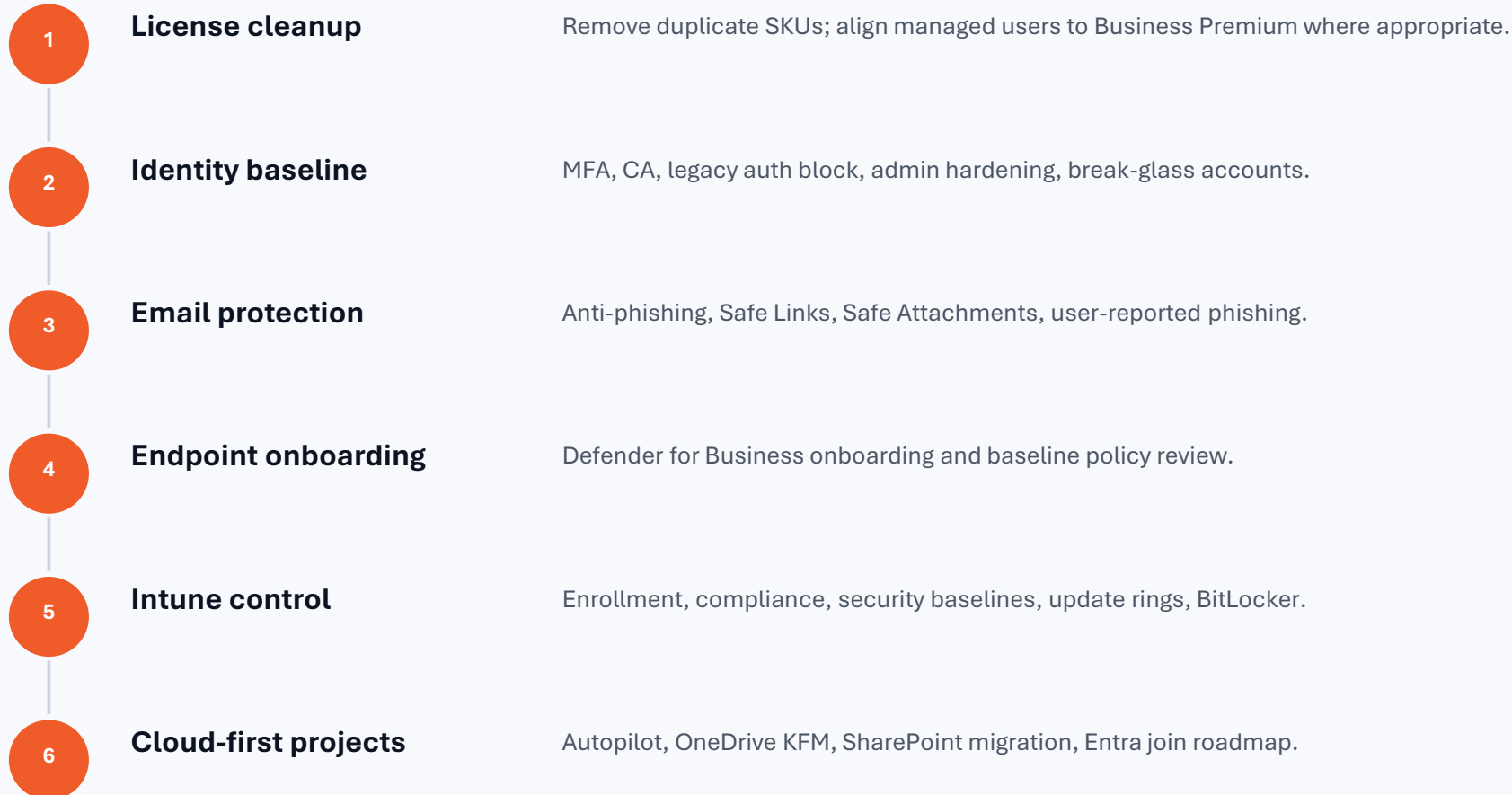
Data governance

Review sharing, sensitivity labels, and DLP opportunities

QBR shift: from reactive support report → strategic risk conversation

Implementation roadmap for managed clients

A practical rollout sequence that can become your MSP standard.



Recommended operating model: package the first 3–5 items as a standard baseline project, then run recurring reviews monthly or quarterly.

Common management objections and responses

“It costs more than Business Standard.”

True, but it includes the security and management controls we need to properly support the client. Cheaper licensing often moves cost into projects, incidents, or support time.

“We already have tools for that.”

Business Premium does not have to replace every tool. It creates the Microsoft-native foundation, then add-on tools can be justified where they clearly add value.

“Clients will not understand the features.”

They understand outcomes: less phishing risk, better workstation control, faster onboarding, safer file access, and improved cyber insurance readiness.

“Techs need time to learn it.”

That is exactly why standardization matters. One repeatable Microsoft baseline is easier to train on than many one-off client stacks.

Recommended management decision

Turn Business Premium into a defined MSP standard, not an ad-hoc upsell.

Proposed decision

Adopt Microsoft 365 Business Premium as the preferred license for managed SMB clients where the client fits the Business plan size and requirements.

Recommended next steps

- Define a Business Premium baseline: identity, email, endpoint, Intune, Windows, and data controls.
- Create a standard implementation package and checklist for new and existing clients.
- Train techs on the six breakout areas: Identity, Intune, Endpoint, Email, Data, Operations.
- Use QBRs/TAM reviews to identify license gaps and propose roadmap projects.
- Document exceptions when a managed client stays below the recommended standard.

Business Premium = the MSP control plane for managed SMB clients